

As with all opinions about programming, you can argue against those I've listed here, or they might simply be irrelevant to your situation. Arguing over how you should write code or what counts as “pythonic” is rarely as productive as you think it is. (Unless you're writing an entire book full of programming opinions.)

Learning to Love Significant Indentation

The most common concern I hear about Python from programmers coming from other languages is that Python's *significant indentation* (often mistakenly called *significant whitespace*) is weird and unfamiliar. The amount of indentation at the start of a line of code has meaning in Python, because it determines which lines of code are in the same code block.

Grouping blocks of Python code using indentation can seem odd, because other languages begin and end their blocks with braces, { and }. But programmers in non-Python languages usually indent their blocks too, just like Python programmers, to make their code more readable. For example, the Java programming language doesn't have significant indentation. Java programmers don't need to indent blocks of code, but they often do anyway for readability. The following example has a Java function named `main()` that contains a single call to a `println()` function:

```
// Java Example
public static void main(String[] args) {
    System.out.println("Hello, world!");
}
```

This Java code would run just fine if the `println()` line weren't indented, because the braces, rather than the indentation, are what mark the start and end of blocks in Java. Instead of allowing indentation to be optional, Python forces your code to be consistently readable. But note that Python doesn't have *significant whitespace*, because Python doesn't restrict how you can use nonindentation whitespace (both `2 + 2` and `2+2` are valid Python expressions).

Some programmers argue that the opening brace should be on the same line as the opening statement, while others argue it should be on the